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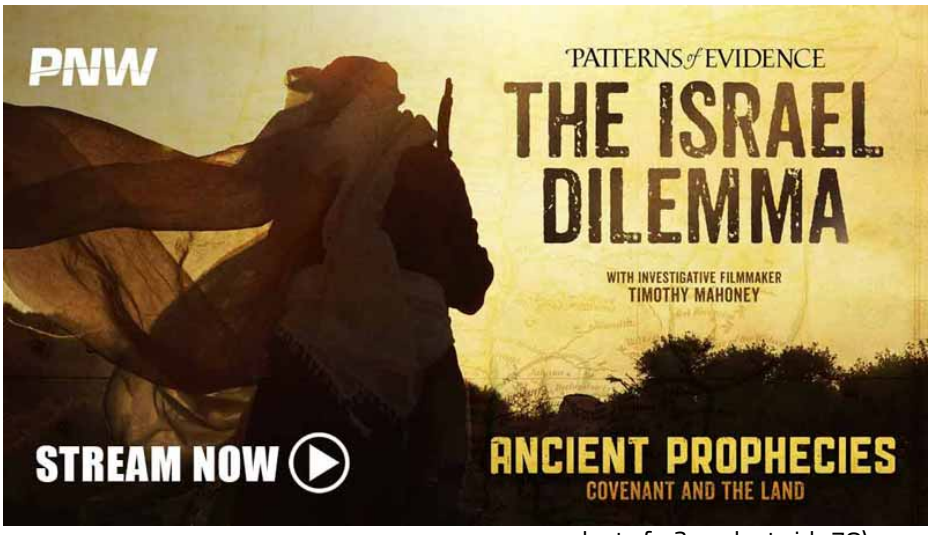
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ARTICLE

When AI Watches Everyone: From Workplace Efficiency To Government Control



BY PNW STAFF OCTOBER 20, 2026

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Imagine a protest in a city square. Cameras record the crowd. Traffic scanners log the cars leaving. Store cameras capture people stopping for coffee. A phone video posted online shows who was there. Today, those pieces of information may sit in separate systems, reviewed slowly or never connected at all.

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Now imagine AI searching them together in seconds.

It identifies faces, follows people across locations, matches a car to its owner, scans public posts and produces a list of everyone who attended. It notices who arrived together, who met afterward and who has been at similar gatherings before. A system built to find a suspect could become a system that maps a movement.

That future is not fully here. But two recent stories show how quickly the pieces are advancing.

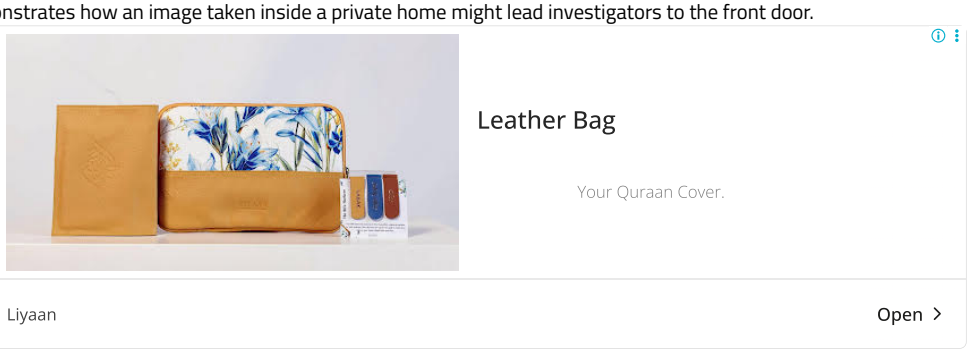
In Britain, Co-op Legal Services has reportedly used AI to record and assess customer calls, scoring more than 50 aspects of each interaction. The calls can involve people seeking help with wills and probate after a death in the family. The company says the system supports quality and coaching. Some employees describe being monitored for hours as AI evaluates what they say and how they say it.

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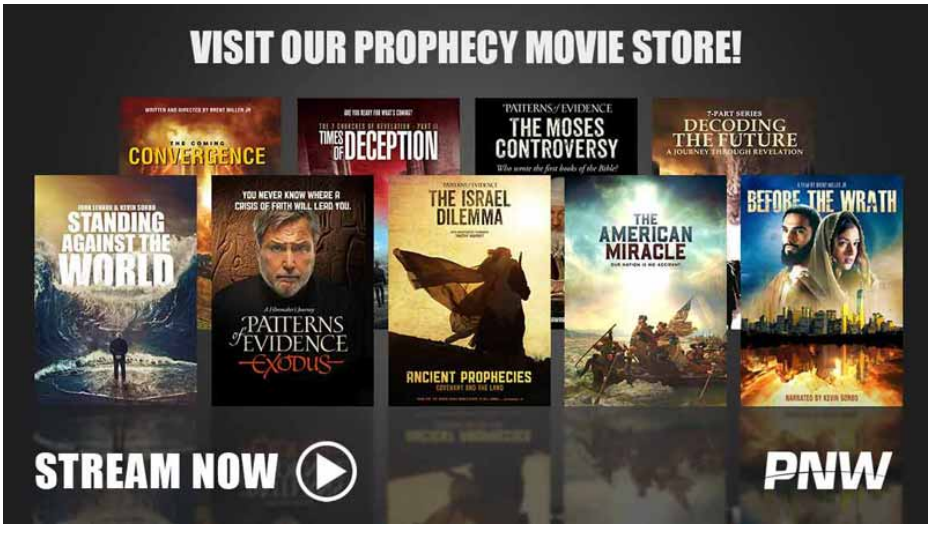
In the United States, police departments have gained access to Raven, an AI tool that analyzes interior photos and searches property listings to identify a possible home. A picture of a room or appliance can offer clues that the software may match to an address. That could help locate a crime scene, a suspect or a victim. It also demonstrates how an image taken inside a private home might lead investigators to the front door.



The promise is easy to see. AI could help police sift through evidence, find missing people and connect clues that would take investigators days to uncover. At work, it could flag poor service or help supervisors coach employees. Used carefully, these tools may save time and prevent harm.

But the central question is what happens as the systems grow more capable—and as separate tools begin to work together.

In the years ahead, AI could be asked to analyze live video from street cameras, license plate readers, drones, doorbells, transit systems and private businesses. It may compare faces, clothing, voices and movement patterns, then connect those observations with public records, online posts and commercial data. Instead of asking, “What does this photo show?” officials might ask, “Where has this person been, who have they met, and what do their routines suggest?”



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That kind of system would not need a camera on every corner. It could draw from cameras and databases already operating for different reasons, then let AI search across them. A city might install cameras to manage traffic or improve safety. A company might collect data to prevent theft. A social media platform might store videos and location clues. AI could make those scattered records searchable as one vast archive.

The next step could be prediction. A system might estimate who is likely to attend a protest, which workers may organize, or which neighborhoods are likely to resist a new policy. These predictions would not have to be accurate to cause harm. A person could be questioned, denied a job, placed on a watch list or targeted for extra scrutiny because an algorithm marked them as a risk.

And once governments can identify people and predict their behavior, the temptation to intervene grows. Authorities could direct police toward certain homes, flag a person at a checkpoint, freeze access to an account or quietly make travel and employment more difficult. A system that begins by helping

A dictator would not need one master score that governs every part of life. Control could be assembled from smaller systems: one that tracks movement, another that monitors speech, another that affects access to money, work or travel. Each could be introduced as a limited response to a real problem. Together, they could make dissent visible and costly.

That is the larger danger. AI does not need to hate anyone, or even understand what it is doing. It only needs to recognize patterns, attach a label and pass that judgment to people with authority. A mistaken label can follow someone through systems they cannot see or challenge.

For Christians, the prophetic warning is especially sobering. Revelation 13 describes a future ruler whose authority reaches into daily life and the ability to buy and sell. Today's tools show how technology could make centralized monitoring and economic control more practical: identifying people, tracking their behavior and enforcing restrictions at scale. A society that accepts constant monitoring for convenience or security may discover that the same system can be turned toward political control when leadership changes.

AI may help find a criminal or improve a service. But as the tools become connected, the line between watching for danger and watching everyone grows harder to see. The question is not only what AI can do today. It is what tomorrow's rulers will be able to do with everything we are allowing it to collect.

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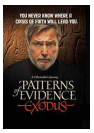
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